
MH@MERICS · WEEK 24 · 2026

Weekly Update

8 – 14 Jun 2026

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I. Highlights

Spotlight 1: Merz backs “enriching” Europe’s trade-defence arsenal - without naming China

In his government statement ahead of the European Council (11 June), Chancellor **Friedrich Merz** opened his run-through of the Council’s issues with trade policy. No continent benefits more from open trade than Europe, he argued – but where others do not abide by common rules, Germany “will not stand idly by”. At the European Council (18–19 June), leaders would discuss how to “**enrich**” the EU’s toolbox; the single market’s attractiveness should serve as leverage to enforce rules for fair and transparent competition, and Europe should further reduce its dependencies on single countries.

Merz did not name China – an omission Belgian Prime Minister **Bart De Wever** had criticised openly two days earlier: the EU speaks of geoeconomic imbalances “only so as not to name China, because we are so afraid that we do not even dare to” (Euractiv). Merz’s substance – single market as leverage, harder trade defence against distortive practices and overcapacity, lower dependencies – points squarely at Beijing while remaining cautious in attribution.

China was lobbying back on the ground the same week. Vice Commerce Minister **Ling Ji** (凌激), fresh from EU-China consultation-mechanism talks in Brussels on 9 June, spoke at the DIHK China Business Forum in Berlin on 11 June, meeting BMWi state secretary Thomas Steffen, Merz advisor Levin Holle and German business leaders (Xinhua readout). Inside the CDU, **Johannes Volkmann** (MdB) made the public case on *Markus Lanz* (9 June) that tariffs are defence of fair trade, not protectionism, warning: “*wir sind erpressbar. China ist bereit, uns zu erpressen.*”

The data underline the urgency. **China’s surplus with Germany nearly doubled in Jan–Apr 2026, from US\$7.9bn to US\$13.9bn (+76%)** on a 19.6% jump in Chinese exports against only 3.8% growth in German exports to China (GACC). In April alone, **German imports of Chinese electric and hybrid vehicles rose 9× year-on-year to €324m** (Eurostat) – with plug-in hybrids essentially appearing from zero (see Top Chart 5).

How firm Berlin’s line is remains contested: a Reuters Breakingviews analysis warns that **Merz’s wavering** undermines Europe’s tough China stance, even as the Commission signals a new trade-policy instrument and the Economist judges an EU-

China trade conflict barely avoidable. The signal is a good start; **concrete implementation – which instrument, with what teeth – is still to come.**

Spotlight 2: Rebutting the rebuttal (OECD vs CF40)

On 1 June 2026 the **OECD** published the *MAGIC Database of Industrial Subsidies*, the first public release of nearly a decade of firm-level subsidy measurement. Industrial subsidies reached **USD 108 billion in 2024**, the highest level since 2008–09. Chinese firms received on average **3–8× more** than OECD competitors. The OECD attributes around **60% of Chinese firms’ global market-share gains** between 2005 and 2023 to subsidies received, against 22% for firms globally. Solar PV, semiconductors and heavy industries top the recipient list. **Below-market borrowings (BMB)** via state and policy banks account for around two-thirds of the Chinese subsidy estimate.

On 6 June the **CF40 Institute** published an English-language rebuttal via Pekingology. Authors **Zhu He and Guo Kai** (Executive President of CF40, previously of the PBOC Monetary Policy Department) examine 2018–25 annual reports of 5,300+ A-share listed firms. Their claim: the OECD account is “*outdated and misguided*”. New-economy firms finance themselves through equity and internal cash, new debt and subsidies flow mostly to old-economy infrastructure, and government subsidies as a share of revenue have fallen since 2022.

The piece lands ahead of the EU Council and the G7 summit, with EU–China negotiations on EVs, rare earths and market access running in the background. The rebuttal uses real firm-level data and pushes on grey zones the OECD itself flags – LPR pricing as a benchmark, sample limits, the unmeasured equity channel, the COMAC/AVIC disclosure blackout. **For European policymakers preparing for Council and the G7, this is the version of the Chinese argument worth pressure-testing.** The table below sets out where each side holds.

OECD claim	CF40 counter	Flaw in CF40
CN firms get 3–8× OECD avg; BMB ≈ ⅔ of CN subsidy	New-economy listed firms run short maturities + equity-led financing	A-shares exclude the SOE backbone – COMAC/AVIC/CASIC are unlisted and OECD flags their statements went dark; that is where BMB lives
BMB benchmark = firm-specific base rate (Fig 3 note: “weighted avg of SOFR and Euribor”)	OECD treats the 1Y Loan Prime Rate (LPR) as the “most preferential” rate – conceptually wrong	The LPR appears only in Fig 3’s descriptive title, not as the BMB benchmark in the methodology
≈60% of Chinese firms’ market-share gains explained by subsidies; no productivity/profitability lift	New economy grew while subsidy intensity fell	OECD’s claim is on share and price, not on the debt-profit symmetry CF40 demands

OECD claim	CF40 counter	Flaw in CF40
Below-market equity not yet in MAGIC – addition under way	New economy is equity-financed, hence market-disciplined	Big Fund I/II/III + local-government LP equity are state money OECD admits it has not yet priced
Period 2005–24 (build-out); CN disclosure quality declining since early 2020s	Period 2018–25; subsidy-to-revenue trending down	CF40 measures after take-off; visible drop partly reflects the shift to aggregated “other income” reporting
BYD subsidy fell from 58% to 7% of net profit; SMIC from >300% to 22%	Firms expanded through internal profitability, not subsidies	Profits exploded while absolute subsidies barely moved; the ratio fall does not test whether early-phase subsidies built the platform

German China policy in context

EU INSTITUTIONAL

- **EU summit draft conclusions omit China entirely:** Circulating texts frame the issue as “global macroeconomic imbalances”, deferring the overcapacity instrument debate to October; Germany did not sign a late-May letter calling for tougher action and Spain – a signatory – subsequently withdrew ([Euobserver](#)).
- **China debate at fever pitch in Brussels as crunch fortnight kicks off:** Commerce Minister Wang Wentao expected in Brussels 29–30 June to meet Trade Commissioner Šefčovič, after MOFCOM Vice Minister Ling Ji’s preparatory talks on 9 June; Brussels sources increasingly expect an EU-China trade war ([SCMP](#)).
- **Beijing cancels two high-level EU meetings over trade tensions:** A ministerial-level digital dialogue – including a session with Olof Skoog, deputy secretary-general of the EU’s diplomatic service – was scrapped, the [FT](#) reported; MFA spokesperson Lin Jian neither confirmed nor denied the cancellation, saying only that “China and the EU are in communication on relevant dialogue”.
- **Commission readies action on Chinese chemicals as overcapacity squeezes EU producers:** [POLITICO](#) reports Brussels is preparing remedies against subsidised Chinese chemical exports – a sector that has lost share to Chinese capacity built behind state support.
- **Šefčovič floats mandatory supply diversification to ≥3 sources:** Trade Commissioner announced the proposal at an EPC conference, citing Beijing’s rare-earth export controls as the trigger; targets companies in sensitive sectors currently reliant on single suppliers ([Reuters](#)).
- **EU plans “Trusted Partner” EV exemption for UK, Japan, South Korea:** Vehicles from the three countries would qualify under “Buy European” procurement rules for company cars and EVs, countering Chinese overcapacity; Nissan’s Sunderland plant (45% of UK output sold to EU) is the headline beneficiary ([Handelsblatt](#)).
- **VW, Stellantis and Renault submit joint “Made in EU” proposal – 70% of vehicles, 70% local content:** The three OEMs (60%+ of EU production) ask for a simpler IAA framework requiring 70% of EU vehicles to contain 70% EU-27 + EFTA content, expanded “super credits” for all EVs built in the bloc, and a battery-localisation deadline pushed from 2028 to 2030. Non-European makers (Honda, Toyota, JLR) object to the “overly narrow” scope, which would exclude UK / Japan / Turkey-made components ([FT](#)).
- **Chips Act 2.0 + CADA formalise the Trusted Partner Alignment:** New “domestic undertaking” framework restricts strategic-project designation to companies controlled from trusted partner countries; CADA’s six cumulative criteria place China outside the EU cloud trust perimeter; US hyperscalers face CLOUD-Act questions at upper assurance tiers ([Institut Montaigne](#)).
- **Beijing warns the EU against new Ukraine-related sanctions:** China criticises planned EU sanctions in the 21st Russia package ([FMT](#)).
- **Manfred Weber: “Entweder wehren, oder China macht Teile der Industrie platt”:** The EPP chair calls for tougher EU defence against Chinese industrial pressure ([WELT](#)).

G7 AND MULTILATERAL

- **Beijing joins Macron’s pre-G7 video call on “imbalances” but balks at deeper outreach:** Vice Premier **Zhang Guoqing** dialled into a Thursday leaders’ video conference on global trade imbalances ahead

of the G7 Evian summit (15–17 June); Macron is pushing for a G7-China conversation (POLITICO) but Beijing has so far resisted further engagement (Bloomberg).

- **“Three Signals China Wants to Send at the G7 Video Call”**: *Brussels Tea House* – a newsletter dedicated to narrative-shaping in Europe – reads Beijing’s intended messages as: drop the victim narrative, listen to your own companies, step back from the brink.

MERICS

MERICS RESEARCH AND (MEDIA) INSIGHTS

China in 26 podcast: Bernhard Bartsch, Claudia Wessling and Mikko Huotari discussed Xi Jinping's trip to North Korea, Beijing's new measures to safeguard Chinese outbound investments, and the upcoming G7 (15–17 June) and EU Council (18–19 June).

MERICS China Essentials (Jun 12) – *Outbound investment protections + Expanded export controls + Xi in Pyongyang.* Beijing has taken steps to better protect Chinese overseas investments and deter foreign governments from imposing restrictions on Chinese investors – just as the EU mulls a tougher de-risking.

- **China challenges EU de-risking by boosting outbound investment protections** (Sophia Pradels): China's institutionalization of retaliatory and coercive tools in the outbound investment regulations formalizes and regularizes Beijing's coercion toolkit.
- **China's export control researchers eye technology as they move on from rare earths** (Jeroen Groenewegen-Lau): "Beijing policy circles see global innovation networks as instruments of national power and are exploring ways to leverage them."
- **Xi grants North Korea his first official visit in 2026 – while high-level meetings with the EU are being cancelled:** North Korea's nuclear weapons and ties with Russia anchor Pyongyang's bargaining position.
- **Beijing's hukou reform ambitions rise as China's gaokao numbers drop** (Alexander Davey): "The recent hukou guidelines are ambitious. With gaokao numbers falling, Beijing sees a major job-market problem rapidly approaching."

MERICS Comment (Yurii Poita) – *Russian propaganda abounds in Chinese social media debate on Ukraine.* The analysis documents how pro-Russian framings on Chinese social media (Ukraine-as-Western-proxy, Ukrainian forces depicted as "Nazis", Western coalition fraying, Russian strikes recast as counter-terror) circulate with little pushback – suggesting Beijing may be tolerating or even encouraging discourse that erodes the moral and political authority of Kyiv and its Western supporters.

Soapbox 251 – in collaboration with MERICS (Jun 08) – *The EU is China's battery export market.* China's battery export machine and its heavy dependence on the EU; Chinese capital going abroad with the state still attached; rare-earth magnet flows splitting between the EU and the US; the China-Shock-2.0 dynamics building into mid-2026.

SELECTED INSIGHTS FOR MEDIA BY COLLEAGUES

Wirtschaftswoche quoted Esther Goreichy: „Pekings Drohungen können ironischerweise als positives Zeichen verstanden werden, dass die Resilienzmaßnahmen der EU endlich ernst genommen werden“, ”

Fortune led with MERICS humanoid-robotics research – "China builds 85% of the world's humanoids but finding buyers is the hard part" – picked up across ~37 international items including **Macau Daily Times**, NoticiasFinancieras (ES), and other syndications.

Euronews cited MERICS research: EU leaders concerned that Chinese ownership stakes in ports could translate into strategic leverage over infrastructure.

ThinkChina cited MERICS research: A Rhodium-MERICS joint report finds that more than 21 Chinese automakers have entered the EU market.

WTOP News (10.06.) cited MERICS humanoid-robotics research: Chinese humanoids are cheaper than competitors but “far too expensive for widespread deployment”.

The **Westfälischer Anzeiger / wa.de** piece (Nils Hinsberger, 08.06.) drew on MERICS trade data showing surging China-Russia trade since the start of the Ukraine war, and MERICS analysis of shared CN/RU positioning vis-à-vis the United States – syndicated across the Ippen Media network (also Wetterauer Zeitung, Echo24, Leinetal24, Kreisbote and others; print likely incl. *Frankfurter Rundschau*).

inforadio rbb / Welt.Macht.China (08.06.) featured Antonia Hmaidi (MERICS) with ARD China correspondent Marie von Mallinckrodt on China’s AI and robotics push: “dark factories”, state-driven industrial transformation, and the implications for the future of work.

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

The Bundestag’s **Sub-Committee on Crisis Prevention, Strategic Foresight, Stabilisation and Peacebuilding (KSVF)** (Vorsitz Peter Beyer, CDU) heard MERICS at its 9th session on 08.06.

Top charts and visuals W24

Chart 1 – China’s goods trade surplus with the EU hit US\$144bn in Jan–May 2026 – 2.3× the same period in 2021, and the headline number Beijing brings to the EU Council week (Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 252; GACC, US\$bn, Jan–May 2021–2026)



Chart 2 – EU Li-ion battery imports from China rose nine-fold from €0.8bn (Q1 2020) to €7.2bn (Q1 2026), with a brief 2024 dip the only interruption to a steep upward trend (Eurostat, €bn, Q1 2020–2026)

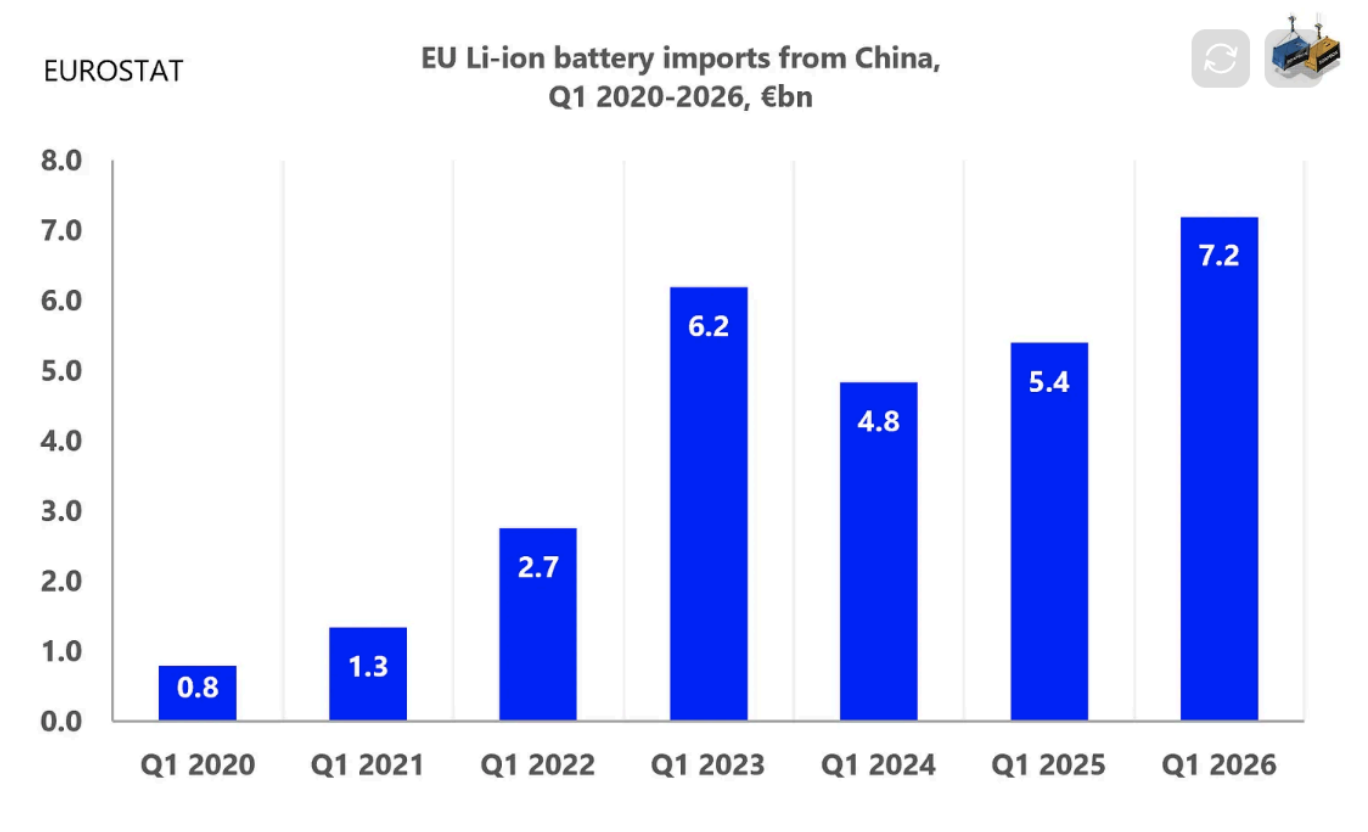


Chart 3 – China’s rare-earth permanent-magnet exports rose to the EU while falling to the US in Jan–Apr 2026 – a split that predates the May Trump-Xi meeting (Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 251; GACC, Jan–Apr 2026)

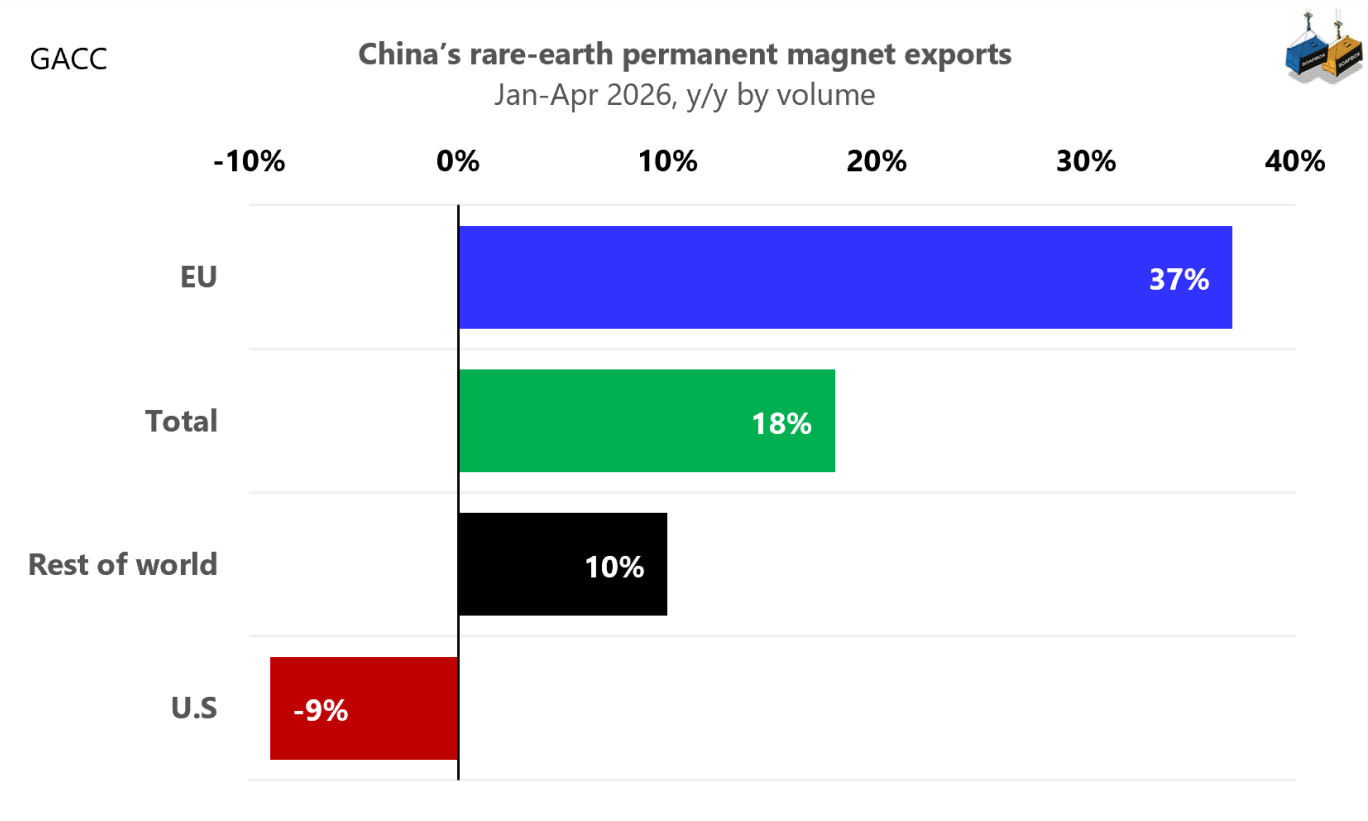


Chart 4 – China’s chip exports rose 90% by value in Jan–May 2026 but only 8.7% by volume – and 111% vs 2.1% in May alone, the clearest signal yet that China is moving up the semiconductor value chain rather than just shipping more units (Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 252; GACC, year-on-year change, Jan–May / May 2026)

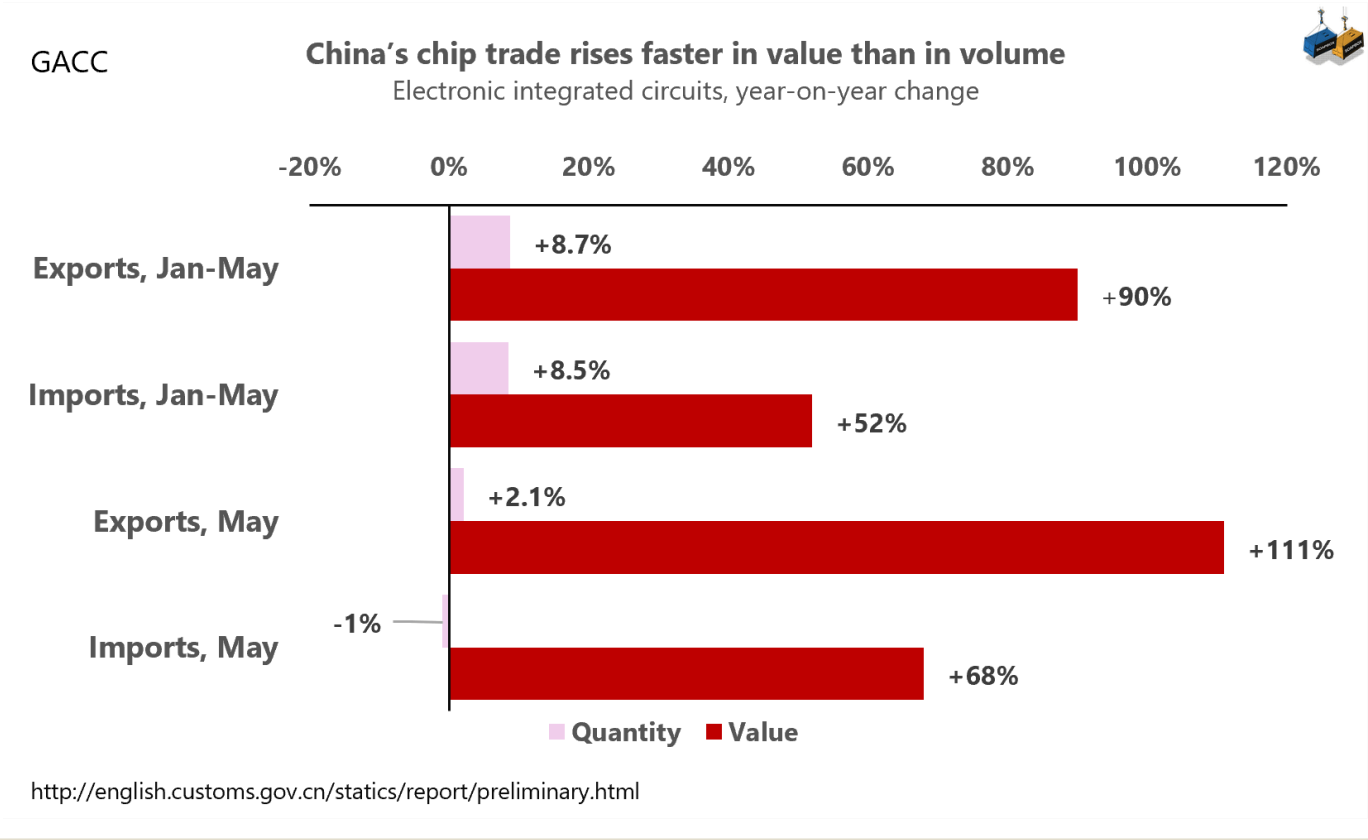
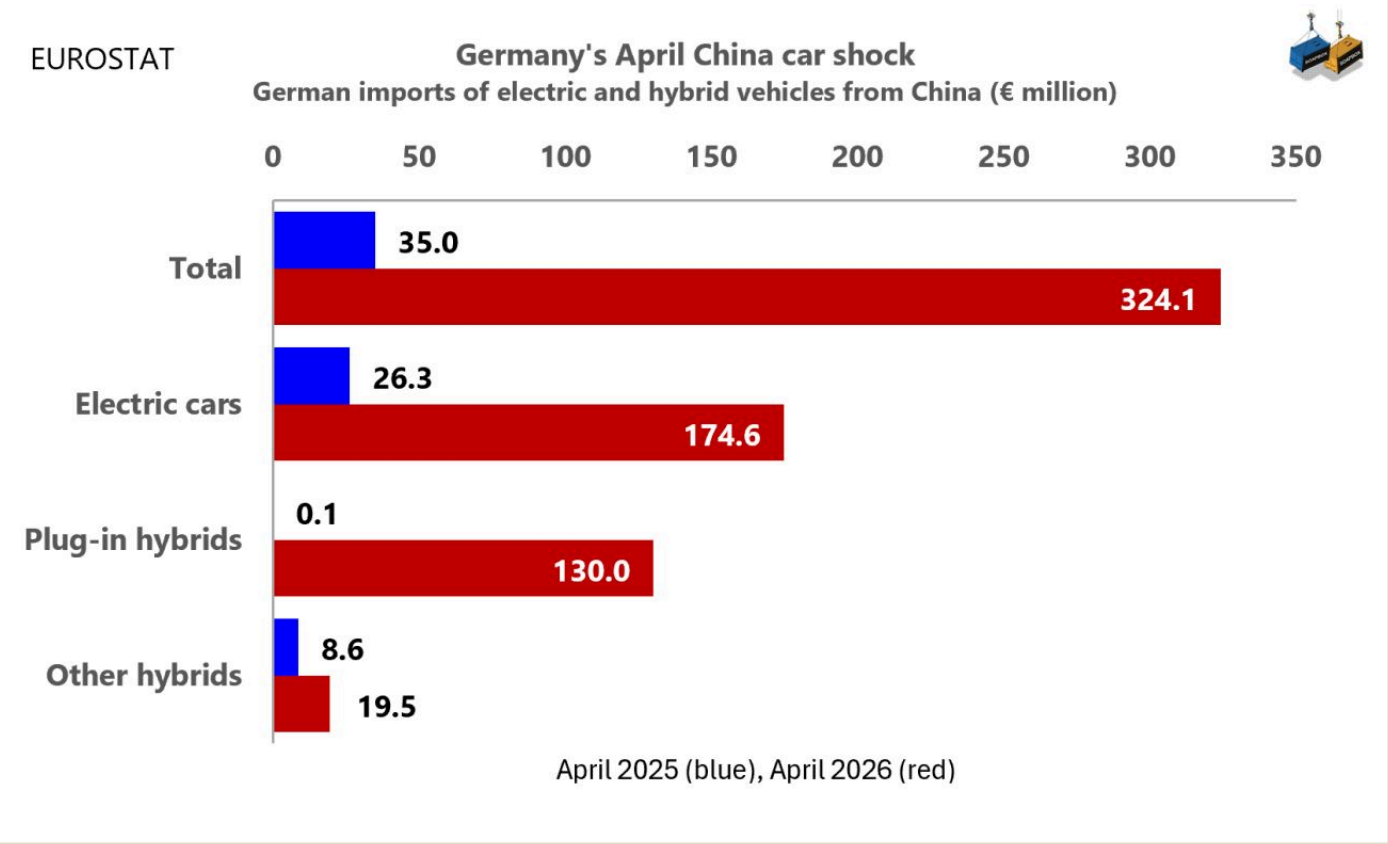


Chart 5 – Germany’s April China car shock: German imports of Chinese electric and hybrid vehicles jumped 9× year-on-year in April 2026 to €324m, with plug-in hybrids exploding from near-zero to €130m (Soapbox Trade × MERICS; Eurostat, € million, April 2025 vs April 2026)



III. International

1. Domestic economic situation and policy

ECONOMIST · 11 JUN 2026

For its own sake, China should change its growth model

- **China's exports rose 19% year-on-year in May, yet retail sales grew just 0.2% in April:** The article argues export dominance and domestic weakness are mutually reinforcing, not self-correcting.
 - **High-tech manufacturing generates fewer jobs per yuan than traditional industries:** Migrant workers' share in manufacturing fell from 37% in 2010 to 28% last year, with many shifting to gig-economy roles.
 - **Local government subsidies for EV and tech sectors erode fiscal standing:** AlixPartners calculated only 15 of China's 129 EV brands would be financially viable by 2030.
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NIKKEI · 10 JUN 2026

China's factory-gate inflation at nearly 4-year high in May

- **China's PPI rose 3.9% year-on-year in May, a nearly four-year high:** Energy cost pressures from the Iran war drove producer prices higher for a third straight month, NBS data showed.
 - **Consumer price pass-through remains uneven across sectors:** AI-related industries can absorb and pass on input costs, while automotive and other weak-demand sectors cannot, according to EIU analysis.
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CAIXIN · 11 JUN 2026

Commentary: The hidden forces driving China's inflation surge

- **China's May PPI surged to 3.9%, beating market forecasts:** The author attributes the reading to supply clearing in petrochemicals and AI infrastructure costs, not broad macroeconomic overheating.
 - **AI-related demand added 2.2 percentage points to year-on-year PPI:** Petrochemical supply clearing contributed a further 0.2 points; communication equipment CPI jumped 6.6%, up 2.4 percentage points.
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CAIXIN · 10 JUN 2026

China's gig economy boom cools, widening a blue-collar divide

- **Blue-collar gig jobs shrank across key sectors in 2025:** China's 427 million blue-collar workforce grew only marginally as ride-hailing, trucking, and livestreaming jobs fell 2-3% amid market saturation.
 - **Platform reputation scores now divide blue-collar earnings:** Didi drivers in Guangzhou with reputation scores above 603 earned 26% more weekly than those below 563; the income gap with white-collar workers narrowed to 2,250 yuan.
 - **Traditional workers face acute insurance and wage-arrears gaps:** Only 32% had work-injury insurance, and 73% of construction workers reported experiencing wage arrears, according to the report.
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In China ride-hailing work is a last resort for rural labourers - The Economist

- **Shenzhen officially declared its ride-hailing market saturated:** The city's ~395,000 licensed drivers and ~142,000 vehicles average roughly 13 orders per vehicle per day (~5 fares/driver/day), the article reports.
 - **A record number of migrants returned home from cities in 2025:** According to Gavekal, an unusually high number of workers who had sought urban employment returned to their home provinces.
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China's notorious university-entrance exam is changing

- **Gaokao registrations fell for the second year running:** 12.9 million students sat in 2026, down from 13.35 million in 2025; demographic decline shows in the candidate cohort.
 - **AI homework use widespread among Chinese students per Economist:** An Economist citation references state-affiliated survey figures on AI homework use and the rollout of AI lessons in Beijing schools.
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'Old people and children are quite similar': China's silver economy shines as births plunge

- **China's silver economy projected at Rmb30tn (\$4.4tn) by 2035:** Beijing is actively promoting elder-care as a growth driver as the 60+ population is on track to reach 400 million by 2035 (~28% of total), up from ~310 million in 2024.
 - **Companies pivoting from child to senior products as births hit post-1949 low:** China's births halved since 2015 to 7.92 million in 2025, with firms including A2 milk formula and education-tech suppliers redirecting product lines toward elderly consumers.
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Nearly 90% of listed Chinese banks fall below profit threshold

- **86% of listed Chinese banks fall below profitability threshold:** The share below the 1.8% industry warning line grew for a fifth straight year, with 46 of 58 listed banks recording lower net interest margins in 2025.
 - **Official and independent bad-loan estimates diverge sharply:** Listed banks report a 1.3% nonperforming loan ratio; Japan Research Institute senior researcher Shinichi Seki independently estimates 9.3%.
 - **Rate cuts risk deepening bank margin pressure:** PBoC signalled monetary easing readiness in March, but economists at BNP Paribas say cuts remain unlikely unless growth falls short of Beijing's 4.5-5% target.
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China adds government savings bonds to private pension investment menu

- **China opens personal pension accounts to government savings bonds:** The June 10 launch added sovereign debt to approved retirement investments, offering 1.63-1.7% annual yields above prevailing bank deposit rates.
 - **June 10 tranche totalled 70 billion yuan combined (3-yr + 5-yr):** ICBC took 23.18%, CCB 19.28% and China Merchants Bank 17.79% of the pension-eligible portion – the three lead banks holding roughly 60% of the new pension-savings bond issuance.
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China's Changchun unveils auto revamp plan, seeks BYD and Xiaomi to boost EV push

- **Changchun's 2030 plan targets BYD and Xiaomi for northern bases:** The city aims to attract high-growth EV makers to set up manufacturing and R&D facilities, diversifying from its FAW-dependent industrial base.
 - **China's auto sector projected to consolidate from 71 to 15 groups:** FAW Group - Changchun's anchor automaker - faces restructuring pressure following years of declining production and sales, according to the draft plan.
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China crackdown brings drone users down to earth

- **New national drone rules sent second-hand prices reportedly down ~30%:** Registration mandates and restricted-zone approvals introduced in May sent owners to resellers as new drone sales stalled, the FT reports.
 - **China's aviation regulator projects a Rmb3.5tn low-altitude economy by 2035:** Authorities aim to concentrate UAV activity in regulated logistics and emergency response rather than the consumer market.
 - **Producers report consumer drone sales declining as industrial applications grow:** Consumer models fell from 60-70% to roughly half of one manufacturer's sales mix, with further declines expected.
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China Postal regulator opens probe into J&T over safety failures

- **State Post Bureau probes J&T Express over safety-management failures:** China's postal regulator launched an investigation into the Hong Kong-listed courier after a series of workplace accidents at its Chinese operations, Caixin reports.
 - **J&T faced escalating penalties before the national probe:** J&T's Hunan subsidiary was fined 100,000 yuan in December 2025 by the Changsha Postal Administration, and the group received multiple provincial reprimands for network disruptions and service-quality failures in 2026.
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China Starts \$11 Billion Three Gorges Channel Project to Ease Yangtze Bottleneck

- **China broke ground on a second Three Gorges shipping channel costing 77.2 billion yuan:** The nine-year project adds a new lock and expands Gezhouba Dam to raise Yangtze annual transit capacity to 336 million tons by 2035.
- **Design changes to protect endangered sturgeon added 2 billion yuan to project costs:** Engineers avoided underwater blasting and altered structural plans, according to China Three Gorges Corp.'s deputy chief engineer.

2. Politics and society

How China Misperceives Itself

- **Beijing frames structural failures as technical or external problems:** Ghiretti argues that Xi's leadership acknowledges economic challenges but attributes them to development stage or foreign pressure, shielding core institutional arrangements from reform.
 - **15th Five-Year Plan consumption priority lacks structural commitment:** The plan names household consumption as a priority but sets no GDP share target; trade-in subsidies faded in 2026 as budgets declined, the article reports.
 - **Author calls for Western tracking of Beijing's shifting self-assessment:** US and European policymakers must monitor how China's sense of strength changed after its 2025 export controls successfully reversed U.S. tariff pressure, Ghiretti argues.
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The Economic Downturn and China's Silent Press

- **CCP propaganda authorities restricted negative economic reporting throughout 2025:** The Central Propaganda Department and Cyberspace Administration limited how outlets and self-media could cover real estate declines, unemployment, and local fiscal pressures, multiple journalists told Tian Jian.
 - **Negative economic story pitches blocked at Chinese editorial meetings:** Journalists told Tian Jian that property default, unemployment, and rural hardship pitches are rejected outright or redirected toward "policy support" angles before reaching formal editorial discussion.
 - **Authorities substitute euphemisms for direct economic decline terminology:** A former Guizhou propaganda official told Tian Jian that "flexible employment," "personnel optimization," and "phase-specific pressures" replace unemployment, layoffs, and business difficulties in official communications to prevent public alarm.
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China's Xi projects strength. His constant purges reveal insecurity

- **Wang Qishan's final deputy detained by anti-corruption apparatus:** Xi's disciplinary apparatus last week investigated the last of former enforcer Wang Qishan's five principal lieutenants, the article reports.
 - **Purge reflects shift to totalitarianism, Pei argues:** Minxin Pei argues Xi moved China from authoritarian toward totalitarian rule, where loyalty is unconditional from subordinates but Xi owes nothing in return.
 - **Xi maneuvering for fourth term ahead of 2027 Party Congress:** At 72, purges function as pre-emption against potential rival networks in the succession cycle, according to Pei.
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Shanghai Vice Mayor Chen Yujian Placed Under Investigation

- **Shanghai vice mayor Chen Yujian investigated for corruption:** The CCDI and National Commission of Supervision announced a disciplinary review for "serious violations of discipline and law" on 11 June.
 - **Chen is the third senior Shanghai official to fall since 2022:** He was previously district chief of Songjiang when the Lianbi Financial peer-to-peer lending collapse left 1.1 million victims with losses exceeding 12.5 billion yuan (\$1.8 billion).
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Why the new party academy role held by Xi Jinping's chief of staff is important in China

- **Cai Qi appointed head of the Central Party School:** Xi Jinping's chief of staff, the fifth-ranked Politburo Standing Committee member, now leads the party's primary cadre training institution, SCMP reports.
 - **Role historically reserved for heirs apparent or top ideologues:** Both Xi and Hu Jintao led the school before ascending to power; the appointment breaks this pattern by going to a loyalist rather than a designated successor.
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China bans 11 online activities under tighter rules to curb rumours, cyberbullies

- **CAC bans 11 content types for multiplatform creators:** New rules prohibit fabricating topics, recycling old news, and inciting social antagonism, with regulations taking effect September 1.
 - **Minors under 16 barred from hosting live streams:** Those aged 16-18 must complete age verification and obtain parental or guardian consent before entering the field.
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A dropout-turned-influencer shakes up Chinese science

- **Dean-level scholars disciplined after influencer exposed data fabrication:** Geng Hongwei's videos documenting faked cancer-research results in Springer Nature journals prompted disciplinary action at Tongji (Wang Ping demoted), Nankai, and Sun Yat-sen universities.
 - **Publication quotas and cash bonuses drive structural academic misconduct:** China's funding model ties promotions and grants to paper volume, with explicit cash rewards that incentivise quantity over rigour, the article reports.
 - **State endorsement of Geng reversed after platforms curbed his posts:** Xinhua initially backed him; officials then signalled he should stop pursuing cases - echoing the party's 2010 shutdown of corruption-exposing citizen journalists.
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Rare protest over animal abuse spotlights China's 'mass-movement' fears

- **Chongqing police dispersed a rare animal welfare protest and scrubbed related posts:** Crowds gathered outside the home of a man accused of abusing adopted dogs; videos showing police handling of protesters were removed from Weibo.
- **China's absence of animal cruelty laws leaves perpetrators unpunished:** Authorities operate under wildlife protection statutes only, and the detained man faces administrative - not criminal - charges, according to the article.

3. Geoeconomics: trade, tech, finance, investment

In Depth: Beijing Rewrites the Rules for Chinese Capital Going Global

- **China's State Council issues first comprehensive outbound investment regulation:** Effective July 1, rules extend oversight to individuals and cover the full investment lifecycle, including offshore red-chip and VIE structures.
 - **National security review becomes a standalone outbound investment hurdle:** Rules directly connect overseas investment with export controls and data security, barring technology transfer via offshore personnel or R&D centres.
 - **New rules establish a legal shield for Chinese investors abroad:** Measures include dynamic risk warnings, enhanced consular protection, and countermeasures against discriminatory foreign government actions, referencing U.S. sanctions on Nexperia.
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Liz Cannon on How the U.S. Government Considers Chinese Tech

- **Biden-era connected vehicle rule was designed to pre-empt Chinese EV market entry:** Cannon said the rule addressed mass data collection on drivers and sensitive facilities, and the risk of adversaries remotely disabling vehicles at scale.
- **Trade détente has shifted US tech controls away from targeted ICTS rules:** The Trump administration prefers tariffs, Cannon said, to avoid triggering Chinese rare-earth export controls that would disrupt supply chains.
- **Allied countries have not matched US restrictions on Chinese connected vehicles:** Canada reversed course on EV prohibitions and the EU imposed tariffs only - neither implemented the supply-chain controls the US had sought.

3a. Geoeconomics – tech & innovation

The People's Republic of Techno-Optimists

- **600 million Chinese now use generative AI, up 142% in a year:** A 2026 Stanford AI Index survey found 84% of Chinese respondents excited about the technology, compared to 38% in the US.
 - **China's AI rule output in H1 2025 matched the prior three years combined:** Concordia AI data cited in the piece shows Beijing is pursuing an “employment-first” approach, with labor authorities requiring firms to retrain workers before AI displacement.
 - **CCP must balance AI-driven growth against job-displacement unrest:** The author argues Beijing's legitimacy rests on the promise of rising living standards, meaning it can neither slow AI adoption nor allow it to disrupt labor markets.
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Chinese tech giants turn college admissions into latest AI battleground

- **Alibaba, Tencent, and Baidu deploy AI agents targeting 12.9 million Gaokao graduates:** Each firm launched university application tools - Qwen's “Gaokao Application Expert”, Tencent's “Yuanbao Gaokao Pass”, and Baidu's Ernie assistant - to capture consumer AI market share.
 - **Domestic AI-native app users hit 460 million monthly by April 2026:** ByteDance's Doubao leads with 345 million users, followed by Qwen (166M), DeepSeek (127M), and Yuanbao (57M), according to QuestMobile data.
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China's AI companies dig in as SpaceX, US rivals ready IPO bonanza

- **Chinese AI firms doubled Hong Kong IPO proceeds in early 2026:** AI-related mainland companies raised \$21 billion in five months – more than double a year earlier – even as SpaceX targets a record \$75 billion US listing that is set to widen the funding gap.
 - **CATL projects five to tenfold business growth over the next decade:** Co-chairman Pan Jian cited humanoid robots and AI data centers as key drivers requiring significant new capital for capacity expansion.
 - **Alibaba executive cites 100-day lag of Chinese AI models behind US rivals:** Zhang Chi said China's biggest advantage lies in applications rather than chips or model capabilities, according to the conference report.
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Too much Chinese science is ignored by the West

- **Only one-third of Chinese paper citations come from abroad:** Two analyses of tens of millions of English-language articles found Chinese research is cited far less internationally than comparable American and EU output.
 - **Chinese papers retracted six times more often than Western peers:** Retraction Watch data (1996-2025) links the gap to pre-2020 publication quotas and paper mills, which Chinese authorities have since moved to ban.
 - **Chinese international co-authorship dropped from 24% to 18% since 2019:** The article cites geopolitical tensions as a partial cause, compounding Western researchers' unfamiliarity with Chinese institutional hierarchies.
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Beijing online shopping warning hits shares in Chinese tech groups

- **Beijing regulator summoned five major ecommerce platforms over 6.18 promotions:** Alibaba, JD.com, Pinduoduo, Douyin, and Xiaohongshu were cited for "irregularities" including false advertising and undisclosed subsidy arrangements.
 - **Alibaba Hong Kong shares fell 5.4%, JD.com 2.9% on Thursday:** The action is part of a broader push against ecommerce "involution" - excessive price wars regulators say burden merchants and distort market pricing.
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US lawmakers urge tighter rules on contract chipmakers supplying Chinese firms' overseas units | Reuters

- **US senators urge BIS to close TSMC chip loophole:** Banks and Kim asked Commerce to bar Chinese company subsidiaries from ordering custom AI chips at contract foundries.
 - **Existing BIS rules left custom foundry orders unaddressed:** Officials required licenses for direct chip sales to Chinese overseas subsidiaries but did not cover fabrication orders placed at contract manufacturers.
-

Does the World Need Chinese Rare Earths? Not Necessarily, Say These Companies - WSJ

- **Niron Magnetics building 1,500-ton/year rare-earth-free magnet plant in Sartell, MN:** The Minneapolis startup uses iron and nitrogen instead of rare earths; broke ground in September 2025 and is already shipping samples (Stellantis partnership for EV traction motors).
 - **ZF Friedrichshafen's I2SM motor eliminates rare-earth magnets from EV drivetrains:** The German supplier uses induction rather than permanent magnets to drive the rotor and says the motor is ready for mass production.
 - **Japan's Daido Steel makes high-performance magnets without heavy rare earths:** Honda is already using the technology in hybrid vehicle motors; the rapid-quenching process achieves comparable performance to standard neodymium magnets.
-

Why it's nearly impossible to build a robot without China

- **Chinese companies dominate humanoid robot supply chains:** Building on EV manufacturing infrastructure, Chinese firms produce robot components at scale and price points competitors cannot match, the article reports.
 - **Japanese firms used Unitree robots to demo their own software at Tokyo summit:** Investors urged Japanese companies to find niches rather than compete directly on price against Chinese rivals.
-

China's hydrogen push outstrips Japan's in new fuel race

- **China's hydrogen push surpasses Japan's despite Japan's 2017 head start:** Beijing's heavy investment has propelled China past Japan in the green hydrogen race, Nikkei reports.
- **Iran-driven oil price surge adds momentum to domestic clean-fuel push:** Rising oil prices following the Iran crisis are giving fresh impetus to China's drive to expand domestic hydrogen supply.

3b. Geoeconomics – trade, finance & industrial policy

US firms see China as essential despite rising economic and political risks

- **95% of U.S. firms call China presence essential to global competitiveness:** The U.S.-China Business Council's survey of 175 companies found 90% reporting profitable Chinese operations, despite "reduced rates... increasing competition, rising costs, and regulatory impediments".
 - **Tariff impact and supply chain diversification intensify despite trade truce:** 59% of companies are reassessing supply chains, with 39% reporting lost sales from U.S. tariffs - the highest since Trump's first term.
-

US hits China- and Hong Kong-based entities with sanctions over Iran weapons | Reuters

- **US Treasury designates 11 persons and entities for supplying Iran's weapons programme:** 9 are China/HK-based individuals and companies accused of procuring MANPADS components; 1 HK company is named for its role in Iran's banking network (Treasury press release sb0528).
 - **Sanctions follow a parallel State Department action from 9 May:** The earlier sanctions on Shahed-drone and ballistic-missile procurement drew analyst pushback that the measures were narrowly scoped and spared Chinese banks – framing not repeated in the June Treasury package.
-

US tungsten scrap exports to Japan soar on Chinese curbs

- **US tungsten scrap exports to Japan surged 24-fold in Q1 2026:** January-March shipments reached 590,000 kg - compared to all of 2025 - as Chinese export restrictions severed direct supply flows, according to US Commerce Department data.
 - **China is simultaneously buying up US scrap via third-country intermediaries:** Despite being the dominant tungsten producer, Chinese buyers are reportedly routing purchases through the Philippines, Taiwan, Vietnam, and South Korea as domestic production declines and raw material supply tightens.
-

Trump's Iran war has propelled China's cleantech industry

- **Chinese cleantech exports hit dual records:** Total solar exports reached **68 GW** in March 2026 (36 GW cells/wafers + 32 GW modules) – equivalent to Spain's entire operational PV fleet, per Ember; passenger-car exports rose to ~800,000 units in April (+82–85% YoY) per CAAM/customs data.
 - **Clean-industry FIDs accelerated globally; China is frontrunner ~25%:** Mission Possible Partnership ("Clean Industry Rising", June 2026) reports 19 commercial-scale clean-industry projects worth \$43bn reached FID in the past six months (>2x prior-year pace); China leads with ~25% of cumulative clean-plant investment, US 22%, EU 14%.
-

China's control over indium phosphide exports threatens AI data centre rollout

- **China's InP export controls since February 2025 have pushed substrate prices up 250%:** A 6-inch wafer now costs \$5,000, with supply shortages rippling through the global optical chip ecosystem for AI data centres.
 - **The bottleneck reached Trump's Beijing delegation and Seoul pre-summit trade talks:** Coherent's CEO flew with Trump's business group in May specifically to press Beijing on export licence delays for the AI-critical material.
 - **Chinese domestic InP producers are scaling output while foreign exporters remain backlogged:** Yunnan Germanium announced a \$28 million capacity expansion in April, but domestic manufacturers told Reuters their near-term focus is China's own market.
-

Japan businesses in China seek transparency in dual-use export controls

- **Japanese businesses in China report rare-earth supply shortages from export curbs:** CJCCI head Homma said companies cannot smoothly obtain export licenses even for items “purely for civilian purposes.”
 - **China restricted dual-use exports to 40 Japanese entities in February:** Beijing framed the curbs as countering Japan’s “remilitarization,” while companies are rerouting supply chains through third countries.
-

Japan’s chip exports to China surge as bilateral trade rebounds

- **Japan's IC exports to China rose 48% to \$28.7bn in 2025:** AI-driven demand for components like MLCCs and NAND flash drove the surge, according to semiconductor research firm ICwise.
 - **Bilateral trade rebounded 6.2% to \$343.3bn, ending three years of decline:** Semiconductor equipment exports fell 2.3% as controls redirected Japanese suppliers toward TSMC, Samsung, and SK Hynix.
-

As de-dollarisation trends persist, can the yuan take the euro’s place?

- **CIPS set a record 1.22 trillion yuan on April 2:** Nearly double the February daily average, the spike came as oil producers scaled up petroyuan settlements amid accelerating de-dollarisation trends.
 - **Yuan is the world's third-largest payment + second-largest trade-finance currency:** PBOC Governor Pan Gongsheng stated in June 2025, with Chinese analysts predicting it will soon overtake the euro in overall cross-border settlements.
-

Why the West Keeps Losing Critical Mineral Assets to China

- **Chinese overseas mining acquisitions hit decade high in 2024:** Firms completed 10 transactions worth over \$100 million - the most since 2013 - the article reports.
 - **Shenghe Resources secured Tanzania's Ngualla rare earth deposit over a rival US bid:** China is on track to receive all Tanzanian rare earth output by 2029, the author reports.
 - **Washington lacks a real-time registry of critical mineral assets worldwide:** The author argues this forces the US into reactive, transaction-specific interventions that routinely arrive too late to block Chinese acquisitions.
-

OECD's Subsidy-Centric Narrative of China's Emerging Industries

- **Only 22% of new A-share debt flowed to emerging-industry sectors in 2018-2025:** Construction, utilities, and transport absorbed over half, per a CF40 study of 5,300 listed companies.
 - **Government subsidies peaked in 2022 and fell 23% by 2025:** Around two-thirds accrued to old-economy sectors; new economy firms financed expansion primarily through equity and internal cash flow.
 - **CF40 authors find the OECD's credit-subsidy methodology flawed:** Using China’s LPR as a floor overstates subsidies, since 49% of Chinese loans were priced below it in March 2026.
-

China's EV giants are breathing new life into Europe's ailing car industry

- **Chery-Nissan MOU targets Sunderland plant for Chinese vehicle assembly:** Chery passenger vehicles could begin production at Britain's largest auto plant - around 6,000 workers - using spare capacity from H1 2027, under a preliminary agreement.
 - **Chinese carmakers shift from export-oriented to embedded European manufacturers:** The article reports a broader move toward local assembly, R&D centres, and supply chain investments across Europe, with established European and Japanese manufacturers providing underused factory capacity.
-

China's BYD claims Germany's plug-in hybrid crown, disrupting market of iconic auto giants

- **BYD led Germany's plug-in hybrid market in May:** The Atto 2 DM-i was the top-selling model, with total BYD registrations up 232 per cent year-on-year to 6,169 units.
 - **BYD posted record overseas sales of 160,000 units in May:** The 80 per cent annual rise left foreign markets accounting for more than 41 per cent of the company's total monthly sales.
 - **BYD chairman targets global volume leadership within five years:** Wang Chuanfu declared "the worst is over" at the shareholder meeting, with BYD on track to exceed its 2026 target of 1.5 million overseas vehicles.
-

Turkey halts BYD tax break, warns of clawback if it misses \$1bn plan

- **Turkey suspended BYD's import tax exemptions after construction stalled:** The Turkish Industry Ministry confirmed the suspension in early 2026, warning BYD faces clawback obligations if the \$1 billion factory commitment goes unmet.
 - **BYD sales in Turkey collapsed following the removal of incentives:** Monthly sales fell from 3,866 in January to 152 in May 2026, after the company confirmed Hungary remains its primary European production priority.
-

China's ports are by far the most efficient in the world: World Bank study

- **Seven Chinese ports ranked in world's top 10 for container efficiency:** World Bank and S&P Global's Container Port Performance Index placed Fuzhou first and Dalian second globally in 2025.
 - **Automation and inter-port competition cited as key drivers:** The report attributes East and South Asia's dominance to export focus, infrastructure investment, and operational discipline, using Ningbo as a case study.
-

A bachelor's in rare earths? In China, there are schools for that

- **China runs 40+ rare earth labs and 11 universities enrolling 500+ students annually:** Reuters' first systematic tally reveals an academic-industry pipeline sustaining Beijing's grip on global refined rare earths supplies.
- **No school outside China offers a dedicated rare earths undergraduate degree:** The US awarded just over 200 generalist mining and metallurgy degrees in 2023, the latest year with nationwide figures available.

4. Foreign policy and 'Global China'

Will Trump abandon Taiwan?

- **Hegseth dropped Taiwan from his Shangri-La speech as PLA pressure intensified:** PLA warplanes crossed the Taiwan Strait median line more frequently and navy ships circled the island more regularly in the year since his previous visit, the article notes.
 - **Trump called the \$14bn Taiwan arms package a China negotiating chip:** He told Fox News the package was "in abeyance" and "depends on China" - the article describes this as an unprecedented linkage by a US president between arms sales and Beijing's preferences.
 - **Brookings analyst argues Xi secured three Taiwan concessions from Trump:** Ryan Hass says Beijing obtained the appearance of US prioritising China over Taiwan, a gatekeeper role on cross-strait decisions, and deliberate uncertainty in future US cross-strait policy.
-

US Allies Start Testing Xi on Taiwan as Trump Treads Carefully - Bloomberg

- **Japan and Philippines deepened defence ties amid US silence on Taiwan:** The two nations agreed to open military information-sharing talks and resolve maritime borders east of Taiwan, prompting Chinese coast guard patrols and warnings of "unprecedented" countermeasures.
 - **Trump administration signalled a quieter stance on Taiwan:** Defence Secretary Hegseth avoided mentioning Taiwan at a Singapore security forum - the first Pentagon chief to do so in over a decade - while a \$14 billion arms package remains under review.
-

Japan's new defense document to name China the biggest concern

- **Japan's annual defence white paper designates China its most serious security concern:** The document details a 6 December 2025 radar-lock incident (~30 minutes) involving Chinese military jets targeting Japan Air Self-Defense Force aircraft.
 - **Paper cites North Korea threat as more serious and imminent than before:** It flags that Pyongyang's military cooperation with Russia could fuel a medium- to long-term military buildup.
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BLOOMBERG · 4 JUN 2026

China Imposes Its First Travel Bans on New Zealand Lawmakers Over Taiwan Trip - Bloomberg

- **China's first travel bans target New Zealand lawmakers:** Four MPs are barred from mainland China, Hong Kong, and Macau for one year following a cross-party delegation visit to Taiwan in May.
 - **Chinese embassy conditioned lifting the bans on a formal apology:** All four MPs refused; one called the measures an attempt to deter future parliamentary visits to Taiwan.
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REUTERS · 9 JUN 2026

Taiwan simulates destroying an invading Chinese force in coastal drill | Reuters

- **Taiwan simulated repelling a Chinese amphibious assault at Taichung:** Eight firing positions used Thunderbolt-2000 rocket systems and U.S.-made Paladin howitzers across a 20 km coastal stretch in central Taiwan.
 - **Preparation time cut from one week to one day to raise exercise realism:** Taiwan's military said this marked the Thunderbolt-2000's first live-fire use in an operational area in seven years.
 - **Taiwan's Mainland Affairs Council head invoked deterrence against Chinese pressure:** Chiu Chui-cheng told media Taiwan will use "sufficient deterrent capability" to prevent the CCP from altering the status quo by force.
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SPIEGEL · 12 JUN 2026

China dringt erstmals in Sperrgewässer um Taiping-Insel ein

- **Two Chinese vessels entered Taiping Island's restricted waters for the first time:** Taiwan's coast guard reported the ships remained within the 4km exclusion zone for 15 minutes before being expelled.
 - **Incident followed a Chinese security operation east of Taiwan days earlier:** Chinese state media published a map showing patrol routes circling Taiwan, reporting 198 vessels checked and hydrographic surveys conducted.
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NIKKEI · 12 JUN 2026

Beijing sanctions Philippine defense chief over 'erroneous remarks'

- **China sanctioned Philippine defense secretary Teodoro and his family:** Beijing banned him, his wife, and child from entering mainland China, Hong Kong, and Macao over remarks it called damaging to bilateral ties.
 - **Sanctions follow Teodoro's public characterization of China as a threat:** He told Reuters at the Shangri-La Dialogue that the Philippines had "no choice but to stand up against Chinese aggression" given territorial pressure.
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Analysis: Kim Jong Un emerges as winner in summit with Xi Jinping

- **Xi omitted denuclearization language in Kim summit talks:** Chinese state media reported no mention of Korean Peninsula denuclearization - dropping a long-standing Beijing demand, according to the article.
 - **Kim leveraged DPRK-Russia military ties to pressure Beijing:** The article argues Kim used deepening military cooperation with Moscow to extract concessions, replicating Kim Il Sung's Cold War great-power balancing strategy.
 - **China, Russia, DPRK reviving Tumen River sea-access talks:** A May China-Russia joint statement referenced trilateral discussions on Sea of Japan access, the article reports - a development with direct security implications for Japan.
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China arrests US academic Min Zin on espionage charges

- **China arrested US scholar Min Zin on espionage charges on 3 June:** Beijing confirmed the detention of the Myanmar-focused researcher and ISP Myanmar thinktank founder after he disappeared in Kunming, Yunnan.
 - **Arrest is uncommon and follows Trump-Xi summit by one month:** The Guardian reports that detaining a US citizen on national security grounds is rare, complicating the two countries' diplomatic reset.
-

FBI disables 13 Chinese suspected spying websites targeting US officials

- **FBI seized 13 domains used by Chinese intelligence to recruit US clearance holders:** The sites posed as consulting firms and used AI-generated content, professional networks, and payment platforms to trick or blackmail targets, according to the Justice Department.
 - **Seizures coincided with Treasury sanctions on Chinese tech firms:** The simultaneous actions highlight divergence between agency-level pressure and the diplomatic tone set at last month's Xi-Trump Beijing summit.
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US journalist pleads guilty to working as China's agent

- **US journalist pleads guilty to acting as illegal PRC agent:** Thomas Pauken II, based in China since 2010, admitted conspiring to obtain sensitive US government information for Beijing from at least 2019 until February 2026, receiving cumulative payments totalling \$100,000 over that period.
 - **Tasking included recruiting cyber-espionage talent:** Pauken traveled repeatedly to meet potential intelligence assets, was tasked by a Wuhan-based group to find an expert who could help them engage in cyber espionage, and sold US Department of Justice and technology information.
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NYT · 11 JUN 2026

Top Pentagon Official Worked Closely With C.I.A. Officer Later Found With Gold Bars - The New York Times

- **Pentagon's second-ranking official advocated for a CIA officer later found with \$40m in gold:** Deputy Defense Secretary Feinberg contacted the CIA this year to expand Rush's role in a classified China espionage program, according to current and former officials.
- **Rush and Feinberg collaborated on a highly classified China spying program:** The two men's working relationship dates to Trump's first term, when Feinberg led the President's Intelligence Advisory Board and took interest in the CIA's Directorate of Science and Technology.

5. Strategic implications and responses

SCMP · 11 JUN 2026

How will the Pentagon's expanded blacklist of Chinese firms affect Xi's US visit?

- **Pentagon expanded China military-linked company list to 188 entities:** The Section 1260H roster grew from 134 last year, adding Alibaba, Baidu, BYD, Nio, and several solar and battery producers.
- **Beijing condemned the designation as national security "overreach":** Foreign ministry spokesman Lin Jian said China "firmly opposes" the US "overstretching the concept of national security" to target Chinese businesses.

FEDERALREGISTER · 10 JUN 2026

US DoD designates new 'Chinese Military Companies' – 1260H list update

- **DoD designated Alibaba, Tencent, BYD, and CATL as Chinese military companies:** The annual Section 1260H Federal Register notice lists over 70 entities affiliated with SASAC, the PLA, or MIIT.
- **Military-civil fusion links to state programme labels underpin most designations:** Companies holding "Little Giant" or "Single Champion" government designations were listed as contributors to China's defense industrial base.
- **Ten entities removed from the previous January 2025 list:** Deletions reportedly include CNOOC subsidiaries and COSCO Finance.

BLOOMBERG · 5 JUN 2026

Chinese, Hong Kong Investors Banned From SpaceX IPO on Security Grounds - Bloomberg

- **SpaceX IPO bars Chinese and HK investors on ITAR grounds:** Lead banks instructed the underwriting syndicate not to accept orders from China and Hong Kong, citing US defense-technology export-control rules.
 - **Chinese capital increasingly excluded from US tech IPO cap tables:** Geopolitical tensions have reversed a decade-long pattern of Chinese funds backing Silicon Valley startups via offshore structures, the article reports.
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BLOOMBERG · 4 JUN 2026

Trump Jr. Warns Investors Against Putting Money in China at Zurich Event - Bloomberg

- **Trump Jr. warns against China investment at Zurich investor event:** He told attendees “I don’t think we can pretend they’re an ally” (after answering “I wouldn’t” to whether he’d invest), contradicting President Trump’s recent pledge of large-scale investment with Xi Jinping.
 - **Trump Jr. cited China's courts as hostile to foreign businesses:** He claimed no foreigner has ever won a lawsuit in China, as USTR opened public comment on the US-China trade committee.
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YOUTUBE · 8 JUN 2026

Strategic Stalemate: What Investors Miss About U.S.-China Competition

- **MSS-linked think tank grounds summit analysis in Mao's stalemate doctrine:** A Chinese Ministry of State Security-affiliated institute published an essay centring the US-China summit outcome in Mao’s “On Protracted War” stalemate concept, former NSC Director for China Julian Gewirtz reports.
 - **Beijing rejected US-approved Nvidia H200 chip exports to ten Chinese firms:** Chinese customs officials turned away chips approved for Alibaba and Tencent - among others - to force domestic semiconductor development via Huawei, the speakers report.
 - **Wang Yi framed "constructive strategic stability" as binding on successor US administrations:** The framework could be deployed to accuse future Washington governments of violating head-of-state commitments on Taiwan, chips, or tariffs, Gewirtz argues.
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REUTERS · 10 JUN 2026

New Zealand poll shows US seen as more of a threat than China

- **New Zealanders see US as greater threat than China for first time in a decade:** The Asia New Zealand Foundation poll (n=2,300) found 35% view the US as a threat vs. 23% for China, with US friend-perception falling significantly year-on-year.
- **US tariffs and trade disruption drive the shift, per analysts:** Professor David Capie attributed the change to New Zealanders’ economic security lens, noting the pattern mirrors broader trends across Western liberal democracies.
- **Souring US sentiment follows a wider Western pattern:** Majorities in Australia, Japan, and India also view Trump’s second term negatively, according to a University of Sydney poll cited in the article.

IV. Chinese Sources

Regulatory & policy primary sources

CCDI 中央纪委国家监委 · 6 JUN 2026

Beijing CPPCC Party Group Secretary and Chair Wei Xiaodong under disciplinary review and supervisory investigation

- **Announcement wording:** CCDI/National Supervisory Commission states Wei Xiaodong (魏小东), Beijing Municipal CPPCC Party Group Secretary and Chair, is “涉嫌严重违纪违法” (suspected of serious violations of Party discipline and the law) and currently under 纪律审查和监察调查.
 - **30th provincial-level "tiger" of 2026:** At 64 (born May 1961), Wei is the 30th vice-ministerial-or-above official placed under investigation this year per Caixin's tally (headline: 2026年第30“虎”), and the second high-ranking Beijing official to fall since the 20th Party Congress.
 - **Investigation follows visible duties:** Wei was credited in late-May Chinese-state reporting with both a Beijing CPPCC inspection for HK/Macau committee members (24–27 May) and a national CPPCC research mission to Gansu on the new energy system (26–29 May) – his last week of public activity before the 6 June announcement.
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MIIT 工信部 / QIUSHI 求是 · 11 JUN 2026

Three-year implementation guideline (2026–2028) for AI integration with information & communications networks

- **Plan structure:** MIIT-issued implementation guideline covering 2026–2028 sets out 17 tasks across four areas – intelligent upgrading of the ICT industry, strengthening the AI foundation, promoting integrated applications, and enhancing industry governance.
 - **2028 quantitative targets:** more than 30 high-value AI use cases in ICT networks; at least 75% coverage for one-millisecond-latency access to computing power in metropolitan areas; ICT networks to reach an “initial stage of high-level autonomous intelligence”.
 - **2030 horizon:** guideline calls for “significant breakthroughs in core technologies” for AI–network integration, naming AI-driven network architectures, large/small-model collaboration, multi-agent collaboration, and computing-power scheduling as priority directions.
-

Li Qiang chairs executive meeting on future industries, warns local governments against herd behaviour; approves new private-equity risk guidelines

- **Future-industries push:** Premier Li Qiang chaired a State Council executive meeting on 5 June dedicated to scaling strategic future industries – humanoid robotics, biomanufacturing, quantum and 6G named among priorities – with calls to deepen the integration of research, capital and industrial application.
- **Top-level rebuke of subsidy-herd behaviour:** meeting explicitly cautioned local authorities against “—窝蜂” (herd-effect) competition to subsidise the same handful of fashionable sectors – a rare central-government rebuke of the very overcapacity-by-subsidy pattern the OECD MAGIC database (Spotlight 2) tracks at firm level.
- **Private-equity risk guidelines:** same session approved new rules on managing risks in the private-equity sector, with explicit reference to local-government-led investment funds – the public-private-funds vehicle that has channelled much of China’s industrial-policy money.

Government positions & readouts

Regular Press Conference of Spokesperson Lin Jian

- **Japan / militarism:** Responding to Tokyo’s pushback on the China-Pakistan joint statement language opposing any “attempt to revive militarism,” Lin Jian charged that Japan “has torn off the mask of ‘pacifist country’ all by itself” – listing rising defense spending, eased lethal weapons exports, intermediate- and long-range missile deployment, “offensive military capability,” “hoarding sensitive nuclear materials” and constitutional revision; he called for international vigilance against any revival of Japanese militarism.
 - **EU dialogue freeze, evasive answer:** Asked about the FT report that China cancelled two high-level meetings with the EU this month over trade tensions and whether the Commerce Minister’s planned EU visit holds, Lin replied that “China and the EU are in communication on relevant dialogue” and referred the visit question to “competent authorities” – neither confirming nor denying the cancellation.
 - **Iran / Persian Gulf:** On U.S. bases in the Gulf being used against Iran, Lin said “the use of force will only aggravate the situation. Military means cannot solve the fundamental issue,” and urged “parties concerned to halt military actions at once.”
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Japan's Propaganda Campaign against China's Legitimate Operation Will Never Succeed

- **Liaoning task group, Western Pacific:** Senior Colonel Zhang Xiaogang confirmed the PLA Navy’s Liaoning Aircraft Carrier Task Group “is conducting training in relevant waters of the Western Pacific as planned,” that the operation “is not targeted at any specific country or entity” and aims to enhance “combat capabilities ... through far-seas training.”
 - **Counter-tracking Tokyo:** Rebutting Japan MoD’s running tally of vessels, training location and ship-borne aircraft sorties, Zhang said “people see clearly that the Japanese side is playing up China’s legitimate operation to stoke tensions and mislead public opinion. This propaganda campaign will never succeed,” adding the Chinese side “responded to multiple surveillance operations of the Japanese side during the training in accordance with laws and regulations.”
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Japan, Philippines will reap what they sow if they persist in wrong course

- **Taiwan-east waters:** After Japan and the Philippines “unilaterally announced the launch of maritime delimitation negotiations in the waters east of China’s Taiwan Island,” the China Coast Guard ran “law enforcement patrols in the relevant waters” and the Ministry of Transport followed with a “special law enforcement operation on maritime traffic.”
- **Threat language:** Zhang Xiaogang called Japan and the Philippines’ announcement “unauthorized” and referred to the so-called “maritime delimitation negotiations”; he urged both sides to “immediately stop their illegal infringements and provocative acts,” and warned “if they choose to persist in their wrong course, they will only reap what they sow”; China “will take resolute and strong measures to safeguard its national territorial sovereignty and maritime rights and interests.”

CN coverage of EU/GER

China, EU hold in-depth talks on consultation mechanism as experts call on Brussels to heed rational voices amid rising tensions

- **Mechanism choreographed at three levels:** MOFCOM Vice Minister Ling Ji 凌激 met EU DG Trade Ditte Juul Jorgensen in Brussels on 9 June for “in-depth and comprehensive” preparatory talks on the China-EU Trade and Investment Consultation Mechanism (TIC); China international trade representative Li Chenggang 李成钢 met Commissioner Maroš Šefčovič in Paris the same week; Commerce Minister Wang Wentao 王文涛 is expected at EU headquarters end of June. Both sides “agreed to work toward pragmatic outcomes from the first meeting of this mechanism, with a view to stabilizing bilateral economic and trade relations” (Xinhua and ChinaDaily readouts, 10 June).
- **PRC framing: not de-risking, but EU “misjudging” the relationship:** Expert Jian Junbo 简军波 (Fudan): “The EU’s characterization of the China-EU trade ‘imbalance’ – and the measures it has adopted or proposed – are misguided.” Analyst Dong Yifan 董一凡 (CICIR) reads EU consent to set up the TIC as proof of “the EU’s willingness to maintain dialogue” and stresses Chinese and European “industrial structures are highly complementary”; Cui Fan 崔凡 (UIBE) echoes that “China and the EU are far more complementary than competitive”. GT brands the EU posture “de-risking, not decoupling”.
- **Anchor figures recycled across outlets:** Trade flow “exceeds 10 million yuan every minute” (ChinaDaily, citing 2025); 68% of European companies surveyed maintain or expand China operations, “nearly one-third” plan further manufacturing expansion. Roland Berger’s Denis Depoux is quoted on “EU companies actively adapting to China’s dynamic business environment”.

Foreign Ministry calls for withdrawal of illegal EU sanctions against China

- **MFA demands EU correct course on 21st Russia package:** Spokesperson Lin Jian 林剑 said China has “lodged stern representations with the EU on many occasions, urging the bloc to correct its mistaken actions” – referring to the 21st sanctions package against Russia, which named financial institutions, energy networks, military supply chains, and companies in India and China.
 - **“Illegal and unilateral”:** Lin restated Beijing’s “firm opposition to illegal and unilateral sanctions that lack a basis in international law”, and pledged to “take necessary measures to firmly safeguard its legitimate rights and interests” while monitoring further developments.
-

European Union should get over its protectionist impulse

- **"Cold War mentality" framing of EU industrial policy:** Columnist Chen Weihua targets the planned **Industrial Accelerator Act** – which would exclude Chinese bidders from public procurement and supply-chain subsidies – along with the Huawei 5G ban (cast as capitulation to US pressure) and tightened investment screening since 2019. Language: “protectionist and confrontational”, “demonization” of Huawei and Chinese EVs as security threats, “overregulation”.
 - **Double-standard argument:** Chen contrasts EU acceptance of Chinese demand for German/French/Italian cars and Airbus’ 55% share of Chinese aviation against the rejection of Chinese investment. Cites the **Draghi Report (September 2024)** as an internal EU diagnosis against overregulation. Solution: “consultation rather than unilateral protectionist measures.” Marks March 2019 (partner/competitor/rival triad) as the turning point.
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Brussels' dilemma: dialogue or self-defeating confrontation

- **"Pragmatic engagement vs. self-defeating escalation":** Editorial frames Brussels as torn between economic reality (bilateral trade 2025: 830 bn USD) and “geopolitical delusions” – the partner/competitor/rival triad. Critiques the accumulation of political restrictions: “human rights concerns, ideological differences, ‘security’ considerations, industrial policy disputes” plus anti-subsidy, overcapacity, and anti-dumping investigations create “a dense web of political constraints”. Named: **Kaja Kallas** (EU High Representative), the Russia sanctions package potentially hitting firms in China.
 - **Consultation mechanism as the "constructive" path:** Explicitly recommends the **China-EU trade and investment consultation mechanism** as an “institutional platform on which disputes can be managed through dialogue rather than unilateral measures.” Cites meetings between Vice Premier **Zhang Guoqing** and EU Trade Director **Ditte Juul Jorgensen**, and Vice Trade Minister **Ling Ji**, as evidence of functioning diplomacy.
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China-Europe auto industrial chain hinges on EU's choice

- **EU choice: "protectionism or competitive openness":** Directly addresses EU Commissioner statements from May 2026 characterising the trade relationship as “not sustainable”. The proposed **Industrial Accelerator Act** would subject “Chinese investors to discrimination in violation of basic market economy principles”. Complementarity frame: Chinese strength in “power batteries and intelligent components” meets European strength in “precision manufacturing, chassis systems”.
 - **Renault CEO as star witness: Francois Provost** is quoted calling for regional component sourcing in Europe by Chinese carmakers – reframed by Global Times to confirm its own thesis: “Local sourcing of components should be the outcome of this cooperation, not a precondition.” Key sentence: “The future of Chinese-European automotive cooperation depends on whether the two sides can find room for collaboration amid competition.”
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Xinhua Commentary: Why 'de-risking' from China risks undermining Europe's interests?

- **"De-risking, not decoupling" as a rhetorical trap:** Xinhua attacks the EU's vocabulary directly, arguing that "dependency reduction" toward an "important partner" raises compliance costs, deters Chinese investment, tears global supply chains, and deepens internal EU divisions. Consumer frame: Chinese products have dampened European inflation; intermediate goods lower EU production costs.
 - **Balance arithmetic in Brussels' favour:** Cites China-EU total trade 2025: 828 bn USD (+5.4% YoY); EU goods surplus 2025: 128 bn EUR (147.84 bn USD); EU services balance 2024: 194 bn EUR (decade high); China's services deficit vs. EU 2025: 48.3 bn USD. Message: de-risking primarily harms the beneficiary. No named experts – the commentary stands as Xinhua's own voice.
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Europe's preliminary mediation terms on Ukraine issue unacceptable: Peskov

- **Kremlin rejects E3 mediation offer:** Spokesperson **Dmitry Peskov** at the Moscow briefing on 10 June: "Launching mediation by imposing preconditions on Russia is illogical, misguided, and, of course, unacceptable to us." The rejected terms from the **Starmer / Macron / Merz** package: immediate and full ceasefire, recognition of the current line of contact as the negotiation basis, post-ceasefire security guarantees for Ukraine, freezing of Russian assets.
 - **Xinhua's curation as a signal:** Rather than offering its own evaluation, Xinhua amplifies the Russian voice – framing Europe as "far from ready to act as mediators" (Peskov) and aligning with Beijing's preference for a negotiating frame without territorial pre-commitment.
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Possible China tie-ups for idle German auto plants highlight cooperation's value amid Europe's industrial shift

- **VW Zwickau as symbol:** Global Times frames the Saxon VW plant in Zwickau ("an uncertain future") as a test case for whether Chinese investors can save European jobs. Named: **SAIC** (planning Galicia plant), **Leapmotor**, **Chery**, **FAW-Volkswagen**, plus Stellantis plants Zaragoza/Madrid (Spain). Local-politics witness: **Dirk Panter**, Saxony's Economic Minister. Diagnosis of Europe's crisis: "high energy and production costs amid geopolitical tensions, labor constraints, and a failure to keep pace with the rapid global shift toward electrification, especially in key technologies such as new-energy batteries".
- **Fudan expert provides the theoretical frame:** **Jian Junbo 简军波** (Director, Center for China-Europe Relations, Fudan University Institute of International Studies) takes a "pragmatic view" of EU-China auto relations; cooperation between Chinese and European producers "could bring concrete benefits to Germany and Europe by helping preserve local jobs, putting existing capacity to better use".

Caveat: nur stichprobenartig auf Qualität / Richtigkeit überprüft — Coverage nur bis 14. Juni 2026.

1. Prominente Zitate und Positionen zu China-bezogenen Angelegenheiten

ZEIT.DE / FAZ.NET · 7 JUN 2026

Xi Jinping schrieb am Sonntag, 7. Juni in einem Vorabartikel für das nordkoreanische Parteiblatt Rodong Sinmun von einer „unzerbrechlichen und dauerhaften Freundschaft“ mit Nordkorea und rief dazu auf, gemeinsam jeden Versuch zurückzuweisen, der „den Militarismus wiederbeleben“ und die regionale Stabilität untergraben wolle

“Xi-Brief in Rodong Sinmun zu chinesisch-nordkoreanischer Freundschaft”

WELT.DE · 8 JUN 2026

Xi Jinping sicherte Kim Jong-un beim Staatsbesuch in Pjöngjang am 8./9. Juni zu, China werde „egal, wie sich die internationale Lage verändert“ an der traditionellen Freundschaft festhalten

“Chinas Staatschef Xi sichert Nordkorea Unterstützung zu”

HANDELSBLATT · 9 JUN 2026

Kim Jong-un bezeichnete laut Xinhua die chinesisch-nordkoreanischen Beziehungen beim Gipfeltreffen in Pjöngjang am 8./9. Juni als „unzerbrechlich“ und stellte sich ausdrücklich hinter Chinas Ein-China-Prinzip

“Xinhua-Wortlaut, zitiert in DPA-/Handelsblatt-Berichten”

FAZ.NET · 8 JUN 2026

Kim Yo-jong erklärte am Sonntag, 7. Juni, dass der Status Nordkoreas als Nuklearwaffenstaat eine „unumkehrbare Realität“ sei und wies US-Angaben zurück, Xi und Trump hätten im Mai die Denuklearisierung bekräftigt

“F.A.Z. FRÜHDENKER; Was will Xi bei seiner Reise nach Nordkorea erreichen?”

WELT.DE · 8 JUN 2026

Katherina Reiche forderte bei ihrem China-Besuch faire Wettbewerbsbedingungen und verwies auf das Prinzip der „Reziprozität“: Unternehmen in beiden Ländern sollten möglichst vergleichbare Marktzugangs- und Wettbewerbsbedingungen haben

“Weltweite Kontrolle; China giert nach globalem Besitz”

WELT.DE · 9 JUN 2026

Markus Kamieth warnte am Dienstag, 9. Juni beim Internationalen Club Frankfurter Wirtschaftsjournalisten vor einem neuen Ölpreisschock und sagte mit Blick auf Strom- und Rohstoffkonkurrenz aus China: „Deutschland und Europa wird nie ein günstiger Gasstandort sein, weil wir kein eigenes Gas fördern“

“BASF-Chef warnt vor neuem Ölpreisschock wegen Iran-Krieg”

DER SPIEGEL · 12 JUN 2026

Peter Leibinger erklärte am Donnerstag, 12. Juni zur BDI-Allensbach-Umfrage, die meisten Unternehmen hätten ihre Verwundbarkeit gegenüber Lieferketten-Risiken reduziert, soweit es ihnen möglich war; er forderte die Bundesregierung auf, Gesamtstrategien für wirtschaftliche Resilienz zu entwickeln, und nannte Japan als Vorbild bei der Reduzierung der Abhängigkeit von China

„Industrie; Topmanager warnen vor Engpässen“

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 12 JUN 2026

Bert Rürup warnte am Donnerstag, 12. Juni: „Das Ende des zwei Jahrzehnte andauernden Globalisierungsschubs, der Umbau der Energieversorgung und nicht zuletzt das mit kräftiger Unterstützung Pekings beförderte Erstarken chinesischer Wettbewerber sind eine akute Gefahr für das traditionelle Geschäftsmodell der deutschen Volkswirtschaft“

„HRI-Konjunkturprognose; Deutschland rutscht erneut in die Rezession“

FAZ.NET · 11 JUN 2026

Eric Ballbach sagte am Mittwoch, 11. Juni gegenüber der FAZ, der Staatsbesuch Xis sei für Nordkorea „ein enormer Erfolg“, der propagandistisch ausgeschlachtet werde

„NORDKOREA; Die Atombombe ist unverhandelbar“

FAZ.NET · 11 JUN 2026

Eric Ballbach erläuterte weiter, Peking und Pjöngjang seien um eine Entspannung bemüht, die seit Xis Amtsantritt 2012 „alles andere als harmonisch“ gewesen sei

„NORDKOREA; Die Atombombe ist unverhandelbar“

ZEIT.DE · 11 JUN 2026

Moritz Schularick erklärte am Donnerstag, 11. Juni zur „Endgame“-Studie, Russland werde „immer abhängiger vom Handel mit China“; „In den ersten Jahren des Krieges gegen die Ukraine hat sich die russische Wirtschaft als widerstandsfähiger erwiesen, als viele erwartet hatten. Doch nun sind die Reserven aufgebraucht“

„Kriegswirtschaft in Russland; »Europa unterschätzt manchmal seine eigene Stärke«“

ZEIT.DE · 11 JUN 2026

Torbjörn Becker sagte am Donnerstag, 11. Juni zur „Endgame“-Studie: „China ermöglicht Russland, diesen Krieg fortzuführen“ – chinesische Produkte ersetzen westliche Güter und ermöglichten über den Umweg China auch den Import westlicher Waren wie Mikrochips nach Russland

„Kriegswirtschaft in Russland; »Europa unterschätzt manchmal seine eigene Stärke«“

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 11 JUN 2026

Stella Li erklärte am Dienstag, 10. Juni in London, Ungarn habe „im Moment oberste Priorität“ für den Produktionsanlauf im vierten Quartal 2026; BYD strebe langfristig an, 70 Prozent der in Europa verkauften Fahrzeuge auch hier zu bauen

„Autoindustrie; BYD pausiert Werk in der Türkei und sucht Standort in Südeuropa“

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 11 JUN 2026

Alfredo Altavilla erläuterte, ein Grund für die Suche chinesischer Hersteller nach bestehenden Werken in Europa sei, dass die Vorgaben des EU-„Industrial Accelerator Act“ schneller in Kraft träten als neue Fabriken gebaut werden könnten: „Es ist keine Zeit, um auf der grünen Wiese zu bauen. Alles, was man tun kann, ist eine bestehende Anlage zu finden, zu übernehmen und neu auszurüsten“

„Autoindustrie; BYD pausiert Werk in der Türkei und sucht Standort in Südeuropa“

WELT.DE · 8 JUN 2026

Dietrich Birk sagte am Montag, 8. Juni zum 24-Prozent-Rückgang der Maschinenexporte nach China im Q1 2026: „Der zunehmende Wettbewerbsdruck aus China und die sich weiter abkühlenden transatlantischen Wirtschaftsbeziehungen belasten die exportorientierte Maschinenbaubranche spürbar“

„Maschinenbauer im Südwesten exportieren weniger“

WELT.DE · 10 JUN 2026

Axel Plaß verteidigte am Mittwoch, 10. Juni den geplanten Verkauf von 80 Prozent der Anteile der Hamburger Spedition Konrad Zippel an Cosco: „Das Geschäft bleibt in Hamburg, alle Arbeitsplätze werden erhalten“; Zippel mit rund 1,5 Prozent Marktanteil sei „die öffentliche Aufregung nicht wert“

„Speditionschef verteidigt angedachten Zippel-Verkauf“

WELT.DE · 8 JUN 2026

Jürgen Kerner erklärte am Montag, 8. Juni anlässlich der angekündigten Großkundgebung in Berlin: „Die Politik hat in den vergangenen Monaten – auf unseren Druck hin – einiges für die Stahlindustrie getan. Sie darf jetzt nicht auf halbem Weg stehen bleiben“; er verwies auf Billigimporte aus China als zentralen Belastungsfaktor

„IG Metall ruft Tausende Stahl-Beschäftigte zu Protesten auf“

ZEIT.DE · 10 JUN 2026

Stefan Messingschlager argumentierte am Dienstag, 10. Juni, Europa müsse China „systematisch“ begegnen statt einzelne Irritationen zu verwalten; die aktuellen chinesischen Exportlizenzkontrollen für Seltene Erden seien mehr als ein Lieferkettenproblem: „Ein fehlender Magnet, ein wartendes Werk – plötzlich wird Beschaffung zur Außenpolitik“

„China und Europa; China ist nur systematisch zu begegnen“

WELT.DE · 8 JUN 2026

VDMA teilte am Montag, 8. Juni mit, das Chinageschäft der Maschinen- und Anlagenbauer in Baden-Württemberg sei im Q1 2026 um 24 Prozent auf 0,76 Milliarden Euro eingebrochen; Frankreich habe China damit auf Rang zwei der Exportmärkte verdrängt

„Maschinenbauer im Südwesten exportieren weniger“

HANDELSBLATT · 9 JUN 2026

Mitch Shin erklärte, Kims Entscheidungen – insbesondere die Entsendung von Soldaten und Munition nach Russland – hätten „direkte Implikationen für die euroatlantische Sicherheit“

„KIM JONG-UN, XI JINPING; Ein Besuch, der Nordkoreas Stellung in der Welt verändert“

WELT.DE · 9 JUN 2026

Lynn Song ordnete am Montag, 9. Juni Chinas Exportdaten ein: Der starke Anstieg der Ausfuhren in die USA um 35,4 Prozent im Mai hänge vor allem mit einem Basiseffekt zusammen, weil der Zollstreit im Vergleichsmonat Mai 2025 einen Höhepunkt erreicht hatte

„Chinas Außenhandel gewinnt trotz Iran-Unsicherheit an Fahrt“

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 12 JUN 2026

Joshua Tucker erläuterte am 12. Juni im SZ-Gespräch, kommerzielle Chatbots gäben auf politische Fragen auf Chinesisch in rund 75 Prozent der Fälle positivere Antworten zur politischen Führung als auf Englisch: „Trainingsdaten fallen nicht vom Himmel. Sie sind das Ergebnis der Gesellschaften und politischen Systeme, aus denen sie stammen“

„Wie Propaganda KI-Modelle beeinflusst“

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 8 JUN 2026

Holger Hanselka sagte am Montag, 8. Juni in einem SZ-Interview zum Bürokratieabbau: „Wir reden immer über Bürokratieabbau, aber ich habe da meine Zweifel. Mit KI bleibt hoffentlich mehr Zeit für kreative Aufgaben“

„Wir müssen uns wieder verteidigungsfähig machen“

BILD.DE · 9 JUN 2026

Alexander Görbing erklärte am Montag, 9. Juni zum Verkauf der insolventen Perlon-Gruppe an Wuxi Yinda Nylon: „Auch die drei Standorte in Deutschland bleiben erhalten“; 450 der 510 deutschen Arbeitsplätze seien gesichert

„Verkauf nach Insolvenz; China-Konzern schluckt deutschen Weltmarktführer“

2. Wichtige China-bezogene Entwicklungen in Fakten und Zahlen

ZEIT.DE · 9 JUN 2026

Chinas Exporte wachsen überraschend stark: Die chinesischen Ausfuhren stiegen im Mai gegenüber dem Vorjahresmonat um 19,4 Prozent – Experten hatten lediglich 15 Prozent erwartet.

„Chinesische Exporte wachsen überraschend stark“

WELT.DE · 9 JUN 2026

Rekord-Handelsüberschuss: Chinas Handelsüberschuss kletterte im Mai auf 105,4 Milliarden US-Dollar (rund 91 Milliarden Euro) – 13 Milliarden mehr als erwartet und deutlich über dem April-Wert von 85 Milliarden Dollar.

„Chinas Außenhandel gewinnt trotz Iran-Unsicherheit an Fahrt“

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 6 JUN 2026

China dominiert globale Industrieproduktion: Der chinesische Anteil an der globalen Wertschöpfung des verarbeitenden Sektors beträgt rund 30 Prozent; 2025 erzielte China einen Rekordhandelsüberschuss von über 1,2 Billionen Dollar.

„Unfares Spiel der Chinesen?“

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 11 JUN 2026

BYD-Absatz in Europa springt um 270 Prozent: Der Absatz des weltgrößten Elektroautoherstellers BYD in Europa stieg 2025 um 270 Prozent auf fast 188.000 Fahrzeuge; in den ersten fünf Monaten 2026 legte er um weitere 144 Prozent auf über 100.000 Autos zu.

„BYD pausiert Werk in der Türkei und sucht Standort in Südeuropa“

WELT.DE · 10 JUN 2026

Chinas Autoexporte springen um 73 Prozent: Im Mai stiegen die chinesischen Pkw-Exporte laut CAAM um 73 Prozent gegenüber dem Vorjahresmonat; gleichzeitig brach der Inlandsabsatz um 23,4 Prozent auf rund 1,44 Millionen Personenkraftwagen ein.

„Verband: Chinas Autoexporte steigen deutlich“

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 9 JUN 2026

Verbrenner von Chinas Bestsellerliste verdrängt: Der Rückgang bei Verbrenner-Inlandsverkäufen betrug im Mai 41,8 Prozent gegenüber dem Vorjahr, während die NEV-Verkäufe lediglich um 8,1 Prozent fielen – kein reines Verbrennermodell schaffte es unter die meistverkauften Pkw.

„Kein reiner Verbrenner mehr in Chinas Bestsellerliste“

WELT.DE · 8 JUN 2026

Chinas globales Auslandsvermögen auf 2,1 Billionen Dollar: Eine internationale Universitätsstudie (Georgetown, MIT, EZB) wertete Daten von mehr als 161.000 Unternehmen in 159 Ländern aus: Von chinesischen Akteuren kontrollierte Auslandsvermögen wuchsen jährlich um 20 Prozent und erreichten bis 2021 rund 2,1 Billionen Dollar.

“China giert nach globalem Besitz”

BILD.DE · 9 JUN 2026

China kauft deutschen Weltmarktführer: Die chinesische Wuxi Yinda Nylon Company übernahm die insolvente Perlon-Gruppe mit zuletzt 150 Millionen Euro Jahresumsatz und 850 Mitarbeitern; die Auslastung der Produktionsstandorte war seit 2022 um rund 40 Prozent gesunken.

“China-Konzern schluckt deutschen Weltmarktführer”

FAZ.NET · 10 JUN 2026

COSCO plant 80-Prozent-Beteiligung an Hamburger Spedition: Der chinesische Staatskonzern COSCO, bereits mit 24,99 Prozent an einem Hamburger Containerterminal beteiligt, will sich mit 80 Prozent an der Spedition Zippel (350 Mitarbeiter, 75 Millionen Euro Umsatz) einsteigen.

“Warum eine Spedition nicht so einfach an Chinesen verkauft werden kann”

WELT.DE · 7 JUN 2026

EU-Handelsdefizit gegenüber China: fast eine Milliarde Euro täglich: EVP-Chef Manfred Weber bezifferte das EU-Handelsdefizit mit China auf „fast eine Milliarde Euro pro Tag“ und forderte vor dem EU-Gipfel am 18. Juni härtere Handelsinstrumente.

“Entweder wir wehren uns, oder China macht Teile unserer Industrie platt”

FAZ.NET · 11 JUN 2026

China deckt 90 Prozent von Nordkoreas Außenhandel: Rund 90 Prozent des nordkoreanischen Außenhandels laufen über China; der bilaterale Handel erreichte 2025 wieder das Vor-Corona-Niveau von 2,7 Milliarden Dollar, ein Plus von 25 Prozent gegenüber dem Vorjahr.

“Die Atombombe ist unverhandelbar”

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 6 JUN 2026

NVIDIA investiert 150 Milliarden Dollar in Taiwan: NVIDIA-Chef Jensen Huang kündigte Investitionen von 150 Milliarden Dollar in Taiwan an; TSMC plant allein für das laufende Geschäftsjahr Ausgaben von bis zu 56 Milliarden Dollar für neue Werke und Anlagen.

“Die gefährliche Abhängigkeit von Taiwan”

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 9 JUN 2026

Taiwans Exporte explodieren durch KI-Nachfrage: Angetrieben vom KI-Boom stiegen Taiwans Exporte im Mai um 51,7 Prozent auf 78,48 Milliarden Dollar; die Ausfuhren in die Volksrepublik China wuchsen dabei um 35,4 Prozent.

“KI-Boom lässt Taiwans Exporte um 52 Prozent steigen”

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 12 JUN 2026

Chatbots auf Chinesisch regierungsfreundlicher: Eine Studie zeigte, dass kommerzielle KI-Chatbots bei politischen Fragen in chinesischer Sprache in rund 75 Prozent der Fälle positivere Antworten zu Staat und Führung lieferten als auf Englisch.

“Wie Propaganda KI-Modelle beeinflusst”

Chinas Einfuhren steigen ebenfalls kräftig: Die chinesischen Importe legten im Mai um 27,4 Prozent gegenüber dem Vorjahr zu; die Exporte in die EU wuchsen um 7,6 Prozent, während die Importe aus der EU um 1,3 Prozent zurückgingen.

“Chinas Außenhandel gewinnt trotz Iran-Unsicherheit an Fahrt”

3. Fünf zentrale Themen in der deutschen China-Politik Diskussion

Xis Nordkorea-Besuch als geopolitisches Signal

Xi Jinpings erste Auslandsreise 2026 nach Pjöngjang – sieben Jahre nach seinem letzten Besuch – wurde von nahezu allen deutschen Leitmedien als Machtdemonstration mit mehreren Adressaten eingeordnet. Die eigentliche Botschaft, so der Konsens von Welt bis SZ, richte sich weniger an Kim Jong-un als an Russland und die USA: China sichert seinen Einfluss auf Nordkorea ab, akzeptiert dessen Nuklearstatus stillschweigend und schließt Denuklearisierung aus. Die SZ hält fest, das Geschehen im Indopazifik betreffe auch deutsche Sicherheitsinteressen unmittelbar.

PROMINENTE QUELLEN

WELT · 9 JUN 2026 *“Bei Xis Besuch in Nordkorea richtet sich die wichtigste Botschaft an ein anderes Land”*

HANDELSBLATT · 9 JUN 2026 *“Ein Besuch, der Nordkoreas Stellung in der Welt verändert”*

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 10 JUN 2026 *“Das geht auch Deutschland an”*

Chinas Exportoffensive und der bevorstehende EU-Gipfel

Im Vorfeld des EU-Gipfels am 18. Juni verdichtet sich die Debatte darüber, wie Europa auf Chinas Exportwachstum – im Mai +19,4 Prozent, getrieben von KI-Hardware und Pkw – reagieren soll. EVP-Chef Manfred Weber fordert in Welt und Bild am Sonntag ein Ende der „Zeit der Naivität“ und zieht EU-Autozölle als Blaupause heran. Die FAZ analysiert gleichzeitig, ob Chinas Vorgehen tatsächlich unfair sei, und warnt vor einer Überreaktion; Zeit und Handelsblatt mahnen eine kohärente EU-Strategie an statt punktueller Schutzmaßnahmen.

PROMINENTE QUELLEN

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 6 JUN 2026 *“Unfairer Spiel der Chinesen?”*

WELT · 7 JUN 2026 *“Entweder wir wehren uns, oder China macht Teile unserer Industrie platt”*

ZEIT · 10 JUN 2026 *“China ist nur systematisch zu begegnen”*

Chinesische Übernahmen und Investitionsprüfung

Zwei Fälle chinesischer Käufe bewegten die Wirtschaftspresse: Die Übernahme der insolventen Perlon-Gruppe durch Wuxi Yinda Nylon und der geplante 80-Prozent-Einstieg von COSCO bei der Hamburger Spedition Zippel, der trotz Kartellfreigabe in eine vertiefte Investitionsprüfung durch das Bundeswirtschaftsministerium ging. Die Welt rahmte beide Fälle mit Blick auf eine neue Studie über den tatsächlichen Umfang chinesischer Auslandsinvestitionen als Warnung an die deutsche Industrie – und zog eine Linie zu Wirtschaftsministerin Reiche Forderung nach Reziprozität bei ihrem China-Besuch.

PROMINENTE QUELLEN

WELT · 8 JUN 2026 *“Chinesisches Unternehmen kauft insolvente Perlon-Gruppe”*

FAZ.NET · 10 JUN 2026

“COSCO WILL EINSTEIGEN; Warum eine Spedition nicht so einfach an Chinesen verkauft werden kann”

WELT · 8 JUN 2026 *“Weltweite Kontrolle; China giert nach globalem Besitz”*

Deutsche Autoindustrie und der Rollentausch mit China

Die FAZ dokumentiert unter dem Titel „Nachhilfe aus China“, wie Volkswagen und andere deutsche Hersteller inzwischen Innovationen aus chinesischen Standorten beziehen statt umgekehrt. Im Mai war erstmals kein reines Verbrennermodell mehr unter den zehn meistverkauften Pkw in China, während chinesische Pkw-Exporte um 73 Prozent auf rund 809.000 Fahrzeuge stiegen und BYD seine Europastrategie auf Produktion in Ungarn umschwenkt, um EU-Strafzölle zu umgehen. Das Handelsblatt zeigt: Chinas Markt läuft nicht mehr auf deutschen Motoren.

PROMINENTE QUELLEN

FAZ.NET · 8 JUN 2026 *“DEUTSCHE AUTOBAUER; Nachhilfe aus China”*

HANDELSBLATT · 9 JUN 2026 *“Kein reiner Verbrenner mehr in Chinas Bestsellerliste”*

HANDELSBLATT · 11 JUN 2026 *“BYD pausiert Werk in der Türkei und sucht Standort in Südeuropa”*

Die Qualität der deutschen China-Debatte

Ein Handelsblatt-Essay diagnostiziert, dass die Auseinandersetzung zwischen „Chinaverstehern“ und „Chinabashern“ eine nüchterne Analyse blockiert – China sei weder Vorbild noch Feind, sondern ein mächtiges, widersprüchliches Land, das präzise Einordnung verdiene. Die Zeit fordert ergänzend eine echte Strategie statt Regelbeschwörung; die FAZ hält fest, dass Autokratien auch bei wirtschaftspolitischer Effizienz kein Vorbild sein können. Alle drei Texte erschienen in der Woche von Xis Nordkorea-Reise und spiegeln ein strukturelles Unbehagen über die konzeptionelle Lücke in der deutschen China-Politik.

PROMINENTE QUELLEN

HANDELSBLATT · 9 JUN 2026 *“So geht die China-Debatte nicht weiter!”*

ZEIT · 10 JUN 2026 *“China und Europa; China ist nur systematisch zu begegnen”*

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 9 JUN 2026 *“Autokratien können kein Vorbild sein”*